

The 12-bar blues map every chord option in 18 forms, simplest first

Concert B♭, written for B♭ instruments (key of C)

Bars 1–4
I, or something
standing in for it

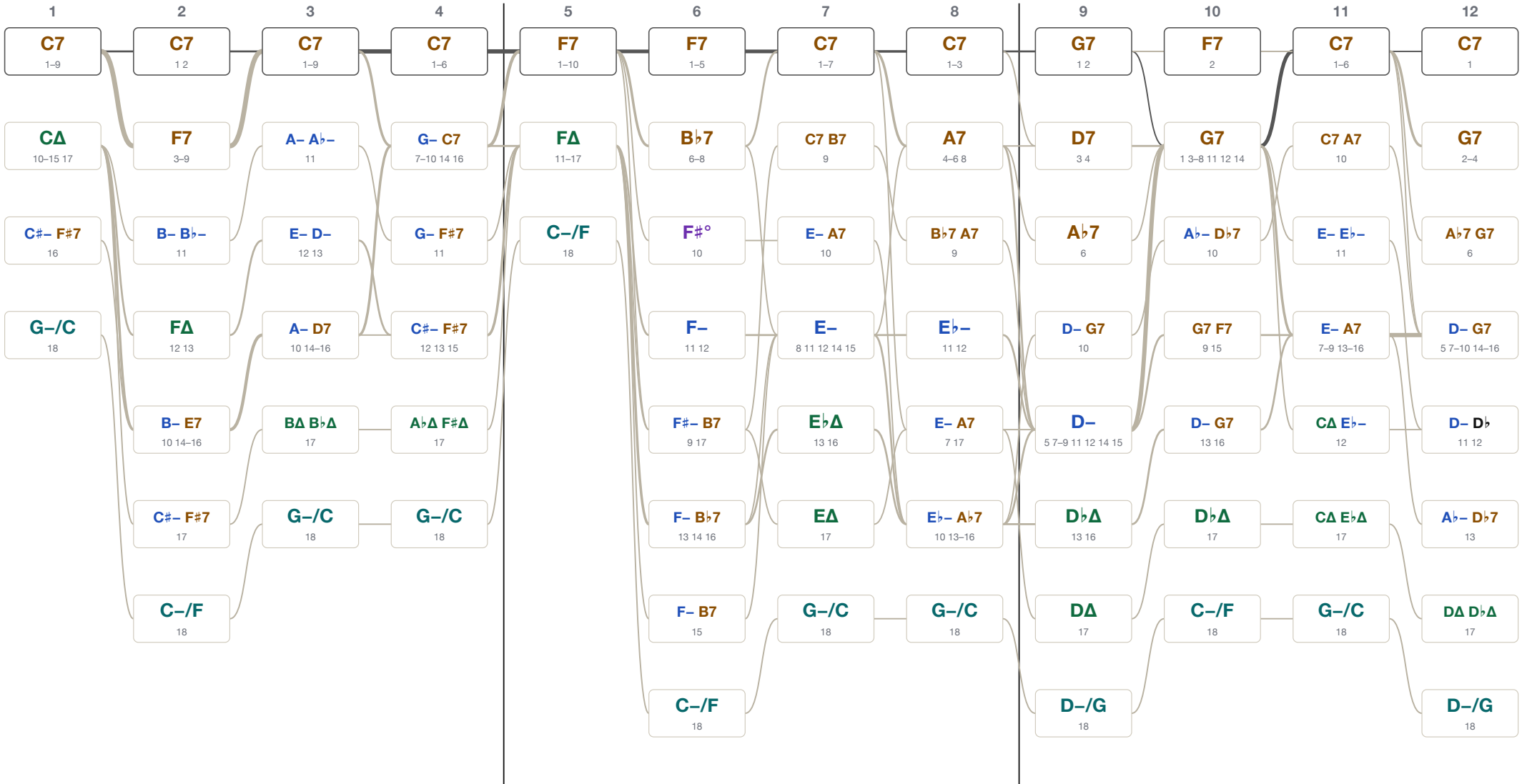
C7 CΔ C#– F#7 G–/C	1 I7 1–9 IIΔ7 10–15 17 #i–7 #IV7 16 I9sus 18	C7 F7 B– B♭– FΔ B– E7 C#– F#7 C–/F	2 I7 1–9 IV7 3–9 vii–7 ♭vii–7 11 IVΔ7 12 13 vii–7 III7 10 14–16 #i–7 #IV7 17 IV9sus 18	C7 A– A♭– E– D– A– D7 BA B♭Δ G–/C	3 I7 1–6 vi–7 ♭vi–7 11 iii–7 ii–7 12 13 vi–7 II7 10 14–16 VIIΔ7 ♭VIIΔ7 17 I9sus 18	C7 G– C7 G– F#7 C#– F#7 A♭Δ F#Δ G–/C	4 I7 1–6 v–7 I7 7–10 14 16 v–7 #IV7 11 #i–7 #IV7 12 13 15 ♭VIIΔ7 #IVΔ7 17 I9sus 18
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Bars 5–8
IV, then back
toward I

F7 FΔ C–/F	5 IV7 1–10 IVΔ7 11–17 IV9sus 18	F7 B♭7 F#° F– F#– B7 F– B♭7 F– B7 C–/F	6 IV7 1–5 ♭VII7 6–8 #iv°7 10 iv–7 11 12 #iv–7 VII7 9 17 iv–7 ♭VII7 13 14 16 iv–7 VII7 15 IV9sus 18	C7 C7 B7 E– A7 E– E♭Δ EΔ G–/C	7 I7 1–7 I7 VII7 9 iii–7 VI7 10 iii–7 8 11 12 14 15 ♭IIIΔ7 13 16 IIIΔ7 17 I9sus 18	C7 A7 B♭7 A7 E♭– E– A7 E♭– A♭7 G–/C	8 I7 1–3 VI7 4–6 8 ♭VII7 VI7 9 ♭iii–7 11 12 iii–7 VI7 7 17 ♭iii–7 ♭VI7 10 13–16 I9sus 18
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Bars 9–12
V (or a ii–V),
home to I

G7 D7 A♭7 D– G7 D– D♭Δ DΔ D–/G	9 V7 1 2 II7 3 4 ♭VI7 6 ii–7 V7 10 ii–7 5 7–9 11 12 14 15 ♭IIΔ7 13 16 IIΔ7 17 V9sus 18	F7 G7 A♭– D♭7 G7 F7 D– G7 D♭Δ C–/F	10 IV7 2 V7 1 3–8 11 12 14 ♭vi–7 ♭II7 10 V7 IV7 9 15 ii–7 V7 13 16 ♭IIΔ7 17 IV9sus 18	C7 C7 A7 E– E♭– E– A7 CΔ E♭– CΔ E♭Δ G–/C	11 I7 1–6 I7 VI7 10 iii–7 ♭iii–7 11 iii–7 VI7 7–9 13–16 IΔ7 ♭iii–7 12 IΔ7 ♭IIIΔ7 17 I9sus 18	C7 G7 A♭7 G7 D– G7 D– D♭ A♭– D♭7 DΔ D♭Δ D–/G	12 I7 1 V7 2–4 ♭VI7 V7 6 ii–7 V7 5 7–10 14–16 ii–7 ♭II 11 12 ♭vi–7 ♭II7 13 IIΔ7 ♭IIΔ7 17 V9sus 18
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The 18 forms

bold: changed from the row above

Concert B $\flat$, written for B $\flat$ instruments (key of C)

Form	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
1 Basic blues	C7	C7	C7	C7	F7	F7	C7	C7	G7	G7	C7	C7
2 V–IV cadence	C7	C7	C7	C7	F7	F7	C7	C7	G7	F7	C7	G7
3 Quick four + II7	C7	F7	C7	C7	F7	F7	C7	C7	D7	G7	C7	G7
4 VI7–II7–V7 chain	C7	F7	C7	C7	F7	F7	C7	A7	D7	G7	C7	G7
5 Diatonic ii–V	C7	F7	C7	C7	F7	F7	C7	A7	D–	G7	C7	D– G7
6 IV of IV + tritone subs	C7	F7	C7	C7	F7	B $\flat$ 7	C7	A7	A $\flat$ 7	G7	C7	A $\flat$ 7 G7
7 ii–V into IV; iii–VI–ii–V	C7	F7	C7	G– C7	F7	B $\flat$ 7	C7	E– A7	D–	G7	E– A7	D– G7
8 iii– in bar 7	C7	F7	C7	G– C7	F7	B $\flat$ 7	E–	A7	D–	G7	E– A7	D– G7
9 Chromatic dominants	C7	F7	C7	G– C7	F7	F $\sharp$ – B7	C7 B7	B $\flat$ 7 A7	D–	G7 F7	E– A7	D– G7
10 Bird blues	C Δ	B– E7	A– D7	G– C7	F7	F $\sharp$ ^o	E– A7	E $\flat$ – A $\flat$ 7	D– G7	A $\flat$ – D $\flat$ 7	C7 A7	D– G7
11 Chromatic minor sevenths	C Δ	B– B $\flat$ –	A– A $\flat$ –	G– F $\sharp$ 7	F Δ	F–	E–	E $\flat$ –	D–	G7	E– E $\flat$ –	D– D $\flat$
12 Major sevenths + chromatic minors	C Δ	F Δ	E– D–	C $\sharp$ – F $\sharp$ 7	F Δ	F–	E–	E $\flat$ –	D–	G7	C Δ E $\flat$ –	D– D $\flat$
13 ii–Vs to $\flat$ III and $\flat$ II	C Δ	F Δ	E– D–	C $\sharp$ – F $\sharp$ 7	F Δ	F– B $\flat$ 7	E $\flat$ Δ	E $\flat$ – A $\flat$ 7	D $\flat$ Δ	D– G7	E– A7	A $\flat$ – D $\flat$ 7
14 Blues for Alice style	C Δ	B– E7	A– D7	G– C7	F Δ	F– B $\flat$ 7	E–	E $\flat$ – A $\flat$ 7	D–	G7	E– A7	D– G7
15 Tritone-sub ii–V into IV	C Δ	B– E7	A– D7	C $\sharp$ – F $\sharp$ 7	F Δ	F– B7	E–	E $\flat$ – A $\flat$ 7	D–	G7 F7	E– A7	D– G7
16 ii–V chain from bar 1	C $\sharp$ – F $\sharp$ 7	B– E7	A– D7	G– C7	F Δ	F– B $\flat$ 7	E $\flat$ Δ	E $\flat$ – A $\flat$ 7	D $\flat$ Δ	D– G7	E– A7	D– G7
17 Major-seventh planing	C Δ	C $\sharp$ – F $\sharp$ 7	B Δ B $\flat$ Δ	A $\flat$ Δ F $\sharp$ Δ	F Δ	F $\sharp$ – B7	E Δ	E– A7	D Δ	D $\flat$ Δ	C Δ E $\flat$ Δ	D Δ D $\flat$ Δ
18 Sus-chord blues	G–/C	C–/F	G–/C	G–/C	C–/F	C–/F	G–/C	G–/C	D–/G	C–/F	G–/C	D–/G